# Harshinee Sriram

Vancouver, BC, Canada

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## Education

**The University of British Columbia, Vancouver** **2022 – 2027 (If the stars so align)**

*PhD in Computer Science* *Vancouver, BC, Canada*

- Advisors: Margo Seltzer and Xin Tang
- **Research Focus Areas (including but not limited to):** AI for Biology, Agentic Post-Training, Multimodal Learning (Video, Text, Gaze/Eye-Movements), Sparse Diagnostic Models, and Interpretable and Explainable ML.

## Industry Research Experience

**Amazon** **Vancouver, BC, Canada**

*Applied Scientist II Intern* *June 2026 – September 2026*

- Built a **deep research agentic system** for high-stakes decision support, with a focus on faithful insight generation and reader transparency. Developed **reference-free metrics** for insight faithfulness and recommendation trustworthiness; evaluated the system with foundation models (e.g., Claude Fable 5) on proprietary data.

*Applied Scientist II Intern* *June 2025 – September 2025*

- Built an **autonomous web task discovery and execution system** for Alexa+, with a focus on tractability and reusability of task workflows. Benchmarked the system on tasks from **WebVoyager and Online-Mind2Web** with Amazon Nova Act and AWS Strands; analyzed planning and reasoning bottlenecks. Delivered a talk at the **2026 Devices Data Summit**.

## Research Works

1. **Harshinee Sriram**, Jon Donnelly, Alex He-Mo, Margo Seltzer, and Xin Tang. "SWARM-FR: Benchmarking Virtual Cell Metrics." Under Review.
2. Vedant Bahel, **Harshinee Sriram**, and Cristina Conati. "Personalizing explanations of AI-driven hints to users' characteristics: an empirical evaluation." In the 26th International Conference on Artificial Intelligence in Education (AIED) 2025. [Link] *(Best Paper Nominee)*
3. Shih-Han Chou, Miini Teng, **Harshinee Sriram**, Chuyuan Li, Giuseppe Carenini, Cristina Conati, Thalia S. Field, Hyeju Jang, and Gabriel Murray. "Multimodal Classification of Alzheimer's Disease by Combining Facial and Eye-Tracking Data." In Machine Learning for Health (ML4H), pp. 219-232. PMLR, 2025. [Link] *(Spotlight)*
4. Vedant Bahel, **Harshinee Sriram**, and Cristina Conati. "Initial results on personalizing explanations of AI hints in an ITS." In Proceedings of the 32nd ACM Conference on User Modeling, Adaptation and Personalization UMAP 2024. [Link]
5. Omair Shahzad Bhatti, **Harshinee Sriram**, Abdulrahman Mohamed Selim, Cristina Conati, Michael Barz, and Daniel Sonntag, "Detecting When a User Disagrees with generated Captions.", In Companion Proceedings of the 26th International Conference on Multimodal Interaction (ICMI), pp. 195-203. 2024. [Link] *(Oral)*
6. **Harshinee Sriram**, Cristina Conati, and Thalia Field. "Classification of Alzheimer's Disease with Deep Learning on Eye-tracking Data." In International Conference on Multimodal Interaction (ICMI), pp. 104-113. 2023. [Link]
7. Anuj Harisinghani, **Harshinee Sriram**, Cristina Conati, Giuseppe Carenini, Thalia Field, Hyeju Jang, and Gabriel Murray. "Classification of Alzheimer's using Deep-learning Methods on Webcam-based Gaze Data." Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction 7, no. ETRA (2023): 1-17. [Link] *(Oral)*
8. **Harshinee Sriram** and Cristina Conati, "Evaluating the overall sensitivity of saliency-based explanation methods.", International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence (IJCAI) Workshop on Explainable Artificial Intelligence 2023. [Link] *(Oral)*

## (Fairly Recent) Awards

- 2026 Biswas Family Foundation Grant for research at the intersection of AI and health (USD 25,000)
- 2022-2026 Four-Year Doctoral Fellowship from the University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada (CAD 24,000/year)
- 2021-2025 Amazon AWS CIC Scholarship (CAD 30,000/year)
- 2024 Advanced Machine Learning Training Network (AML-TN) Fellowship by NSERC CREATE (CAD 30,000)
- 2022-2027 President's Academic Excellence Initiative PhD Award and 2024 BPOC Graduate Excellence Award from the University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada